

MAJOR SUIT OPENINGS

South opens 1♥ or 1♠ (12-21 HCP, 5+ in that major).

North's responses:

- 1♠ (over 1♥) — 6+ HCP, 4+ spades, no fit
- 1NT — 6+ HCP, no support, no 4-card major above opener's suit
- Simple raise (2M) — 6-9 HCP with 3+ support
- 2NT — 11-12 HCP balanced (in some systems this is Jacoby 2NT — see chart)
- Limit raise (3M) — 10-12 HCP with 4+ support
- Game raise (4M) — preemptive (0-7 HCP with 5+ support) or strong with 5+ trump

For beginners: count HCP, count support cards, choose the right response.

Reference:

https://www.bridgebum.com/responses_to_one_of_a_major.php

4NT is Blackwood, asking for aces, or quantitative (inviting 6NT) after a natural notrump bid. Responses:

- 5♣ = 0 or 4 aces
- 5♦ = 1 ace
- 5♥ = 2 aces
- 5♠ = 3 aces
- 5NT then asks for kings the same way